In addition to Passport and Sanctum, Laravel also has Laravel Fortify that can be used for authentication. Laravel Fortify is a Laravel authentication backend implementation that is not dependent on the front end. Fortify registers the routes and controllers required to implement all of Laravel's authentication capabilities, including login, registration, password reset, and email verification.

Passport

Passport is an OAuth2 authentication provider that provides a number of OAuth2 "grant types" that allow you to issue different sorts of tokens. In general, this is a comprehensive and complicated API authentication package.

Most apps, however, do not require the extensive functionalities provided by the OAuth2 spec, which can be perplexing for both users and developers. Furthermore, developers have previously been perplexed as to how to authenticate SPA apps or mobile applications utilizing OAuth2 authentication providers, such as Passport.

Sanctum

Laravel Sanctum is an authentication package that solves a number of problems faced in developing Laravel applications. The package is a more streamlined package that is capable of handling first-party web requests as well as API calls made through tokens. This also helps remove the complexity of OAuth2.

In addition to being an API, it offers a first-party web UI, which means that SPA (single-page applications) exists independent of the backend Laravel application and independent of the mobile client.

Laravel Sanctum is a hybrid web/API authentication module that can handle the complete authentication process for your application. This is feasible because when Sanctum-based apps get a request, Sanctum first determines if the request has a session cookie referencing an authenticated session.

Sanctum achieves this by utilizing Laravel's built-in authentication services, as previously explained. Sanctum will check the request for an API token if it is not authenticated through a session cookie. If an API token is present, Sanctum will use that token to authenticate the request.